

E

EASING Technique for joining two fabric edges of slightly different lengths, in which the extra fullness on the longer edge is evenly distributed along the seam; more subtle than *gathering*.



EMBROIDERY Decorative stitching applied to a fabric, using materials such as *silk*, *wool*, and metal thread.
SEE P.109

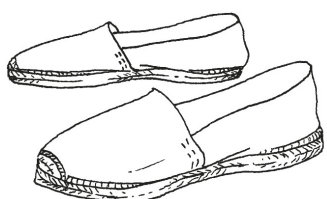
EMPIRE LINE A term used for women's dresses in the early 19th century, featuring a high-waisted *bodice* and long, slim skirt.
c.1800–1820: SEE PP.170–1

ENGAGEANTES A French word for *ruffles*, especially detachable ruffles worn at the *cuffs* by women.
LATE 17TH–MID-19TH CENTURY: SEE PP.142, 157

EPAULETTES Ornamental shoulder pieces originally worn on *jackets* as part of a military uniform; now also a term for detachable shoulder pieces with insignia of rank, worn by the armed forces and other uniformed personnel such as pilots.
18TH CENTURY ▷

ERMINE The winter fur of the stoat (*Mustela erminea*), which is white with a black tip, and in medieval Europe was a symbol of high status.
MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.86–7, 192–3

ESPADRILLES Canvas shoes with twisted rope soles, and sometimes laces, first worn by Spanish peasants but now popular as summer shoes.
1920s ▷



ETHNIC DRESS Traditional clothing from certain ethnic groups that has been adapted for Western fashion, such as the *poncho*, the *kaftan*, or *harem pants*.

1950 ▷

ETON COLLAR A large, stiffly starched, detachable white collar, notably worn by pupils of Eton, a prestigious British school.

19TH CENTURY ▷

EYELET A hole made in a garment for ribbon or laces to pass through, often with the edges strengthened by stitching or metal rings.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE P.63

F

FACE, OF FABRIC The “right side”; the surface that faces outwards on a finished garment; see also *Double-faced cloth*.

FACING Attaching a strip of fabric or binding to a raw neckline or other edge of a garment, to give a neat enclosed seam.

FAGGOTTING (a) Joining of two fabric pieces by a network of stitches; (b) *drawn-thread work* in which some threads are removed and the rest tied in bundles to form a pattern.

FAILLE A soft *silk* or *rayon* fabric with a *ribbed weave* and slight lustre.

1860s ▷

FAIR ISLE A traditional *knitting* style from Fair Isle in the Shetlands, with bands of repeating motifs in various colours or natural fleece tones.

1860s ▷: SEE PP.286, 304

FARTHINGALE An underskirt with wicker, *whalebone*, or rag hoops sewn in to hold a top skirt in a particular shape; see also *Spanish farthingale*, *Wheel farthingale*.

LATE 15TH–MID-17TH CENTURY: SEE PP.432–3

FASCINATOR

A delicate head ornament made from materials such as feathers and net, derived from the cocktail hats of the 1960s.

1970s ▷: SEE P.429



FASHION PLATES Mass-produced illustrations showing the general features of new fashion styles; used until the advent of photography.

17TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY

FEDORA A *felt* hat with a crease along the crown and two “pinches” at the front, first worn by women but now a classic style for men.

1890s ▷: SEE PP.225, 303

FELT A fabric made from *wool* and/or fur matted together by heating, moisture, and friction.

FEZ Also called a *tarboosh*, a red *wool felt* cap with cylindrical or conical sides, a flat crown, and a tassel, traditionally worn by Muslim men in Turkey and North Africa.

SEE PP.113, 453



FIBRE Strands of *cotton*, *silk*, or other natural or synthetic substances that are twisted into *yarn* or *felted* to make fabric.

FICHU Worn by women, a triangle of *muslin* or *linen* draped over the shoulders and loosely knotted at the bust or tucked into a low neckline.

EARLY 18TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY: SEE PP.147, 178



FILLET A thin headband of *linen* or gold, or a headband of *satin* with pearls for eveningwear.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.49, 61, 64

FISHNET Open-weave material used for women's stockings and tights.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷

FLAMENCO DRESS Ankle-length *cotton* dress with a low neckline; fitted *bodice*, waist, and hips; and frilled skirt; traditional in Andalusia, Spain; from local Romani dress.

EARLY 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.329, 445

FLANNEL *Woollen* fabric with a plain or *twill weave* and a slight *nap* on both sides.

MEDIEVAL ▷

FLANNELETTE A *cotton* fabric that resembles *flannel*, with a *nap* on one or both sides.

1870s ▷

FLARES Trousers that fit tightly around the upper legs but flare out widely from the knee down; see also *Bell-bottoms*, *Loons*.

LATE 1960s ▷: SEE PP.366–7, 372–3, 382–3

FLAT CAP A soft, round cap of cloth or leather, with a low, flat crown and a small, stiff brim at the front.

16TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.227, 282

FLOUNCE A deep *ruffle* of gathered or *pleated* fabric used as decorative trimming for women's garments.

18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.133, 143, 146–7

FLY FRONT A fold of cloth on a pair of trousers covering a row of buttons or a zip.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.217

FOLK COSTUME Style of dress traditionally worn by the inhabitants of a certain region, such as the *Dirndl* and *Lederhosen* in Germany.

FONTANGE A headdress for women first appearing in the French court, comprising a tower of *lace* or *linen* frills supported by a *commode*.

LATE 17TH–EARLY 18TH CENTURY: SEE P.139

FOUR-IN-HAND A simple and commonly used way to tie a necktie, forming a narrow and slightly asymmetrical knot.

1890 ▷: SEE PP.211, 263, 288

FRENCH CUFF Also called a double *cuff*, a long cuff that is folded back on itself and fastened with cufflinks.

1850s ▷: SEE P.440